

What do the tree numbers prove?

Comino's removal, transplant and replacement plan, checked against the evidence

THE CLAIM

***“54 protected trees will be removed”
“540 new indigenous trees”***

Environment and Resources Authority, 11 August 2026

Comino · planned removals, planting and transplantation

These are announced conditions, not measured outcomes.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Math checks out;
outcome unmeasured.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

678

specimens for removal

ERA's categories: 624 non-protected plus 54 protected.

92.04%

non-protected share

624 of 678; rounds to the stated 92%.

540

new indigenous trees

Ten for each of the 54 protected trees scheduled for removal.

348

trees to transplant

Separate from removal; ERA says 341 are protected. Failures trigger a further 10:1 condition.

Not shown

ecological offset

No public survival or habitat-recovery results for these Comino trees were available at review.

FAIR TO SAY

The counts and ratios in ERA's published plan reconcile. That supports the factual description, while leaving species-level ecological replacement and transplant success to be measured.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Publish the complete species and condition schedule.

☐ Publish the final species, provenance and aftercare plan.

☐ Report transplant and planting survival at years 1, 3 and 5.

☐ Monitor native biodiversity and habitat function, not counts alone.